

U UniTrade

[Home](#) [Marketplace](#) [Services](#) [Impact](#) [About](#)

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Campus marketplace for real student needs

Trade Smarter. Reuse Better.

Buy, sell, rent, borrow, barter, donate and share useful things within your campus community.

[Create account](#)

[Explore marketplace](#)

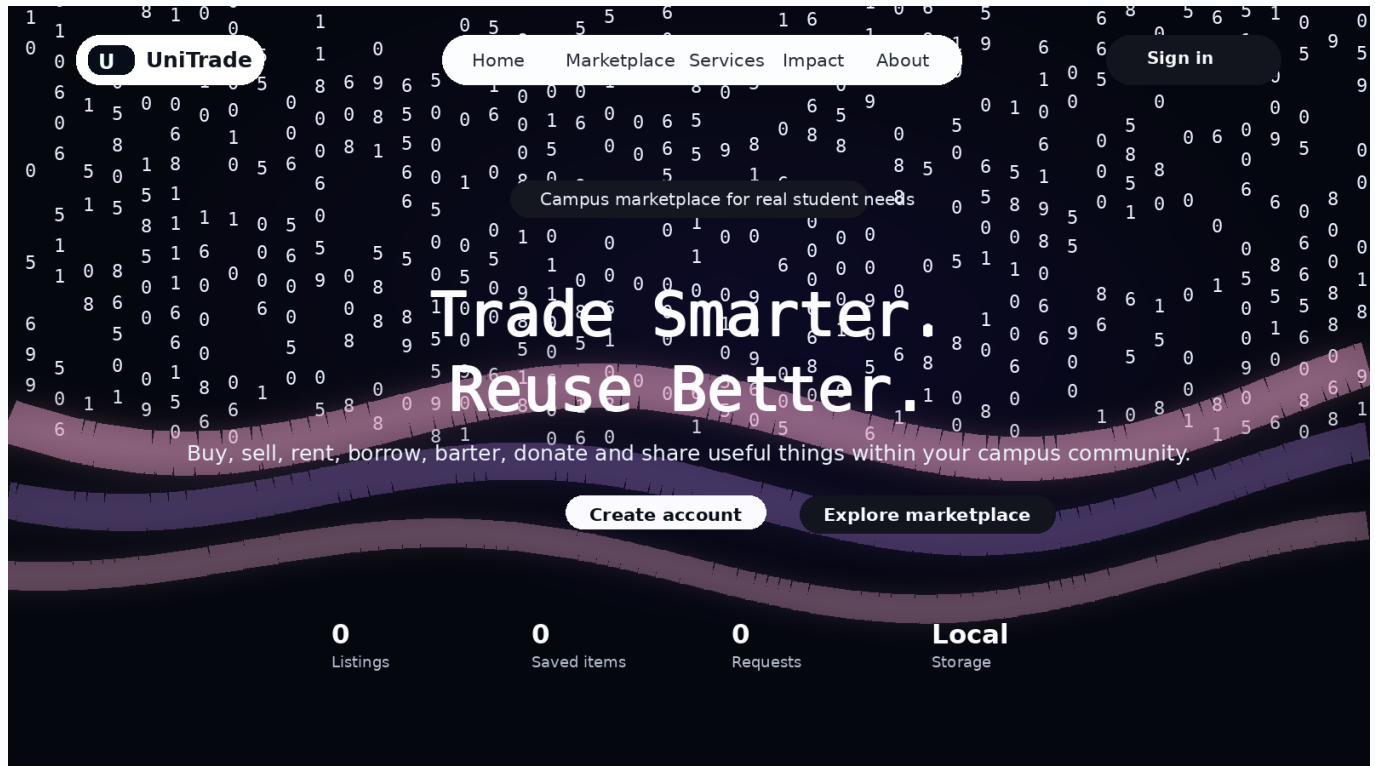
UniTrade - Product Website Guide

How the product works, how data persists, how features connect, and how the architecture can evolve.

Current data layer: browser localStorage

1. Product overview

UniTrade is a campus-first circular marketplace built around the way students actually exchange useful things. Each major job has its own focused workspace rather than being forced into one oversized dashboard: marketplace discovery, Looking For requests, community contributions, rental planning, barter, pricing guidance, Lost & Found, storage, digital resources, impact tracking, safety and product guidance.



Visual illustration for the requested high-fidelity design language: dark field, binary motion, luminous pink/purple waves, pill navigation and strong central messaging.

What the product solves

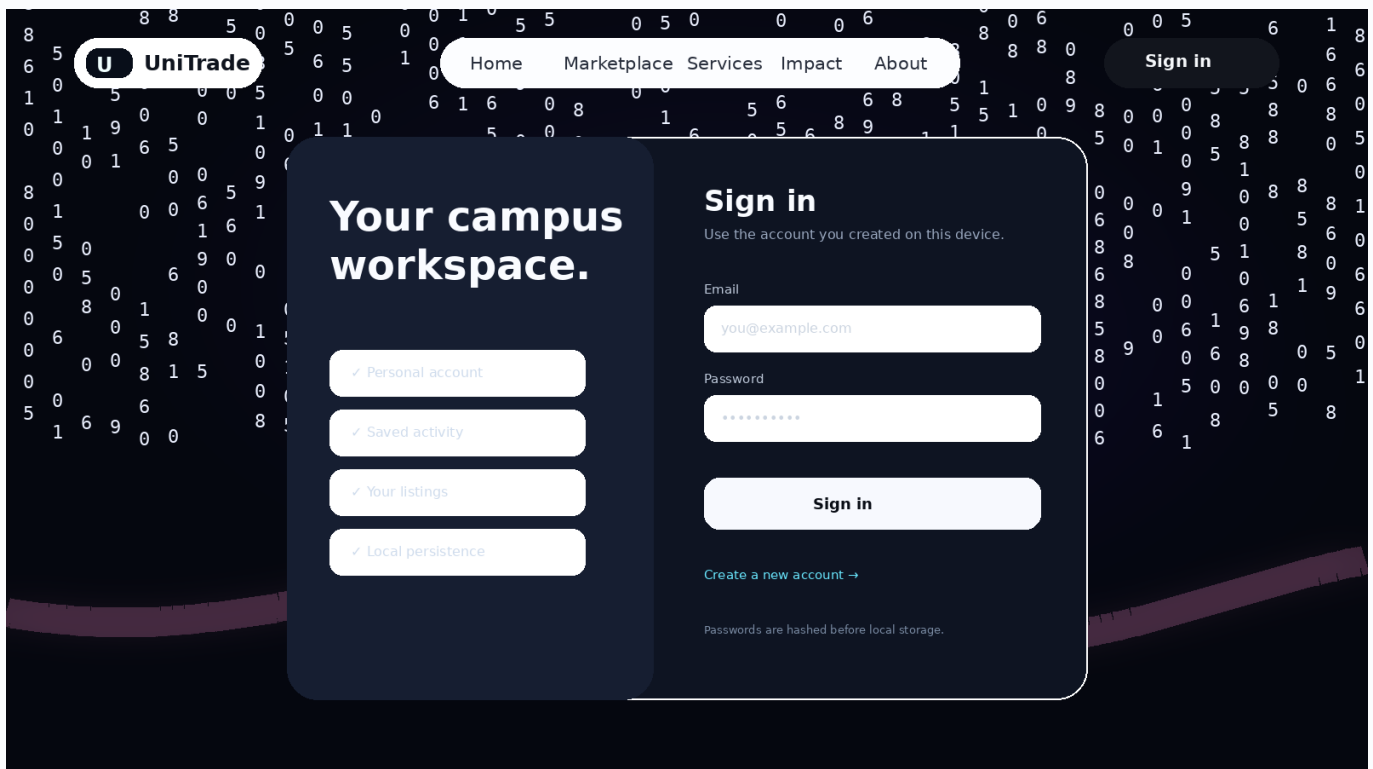
Students often need items for a limited period while other students already own useful belongings they no longer need. UniTrade keeps discovery local and supports more ownership models than a purchase-only marketplace.

Product principles

Local first. Focused views. User-created inventory. Clear transaction context. Safety guidance without unrealistic promises. Data that persists on the device today and can later move to secure backend services.

2. Account and access experience

The website starts with a clean state. No marketplace catalog, requests, notifications, vault resources or community activity are preloaded. Personal marketplace actions begin after account creation or sign in.



Account illustration: two-column authentication, password controls, progressive account creation and local persistence messaging.

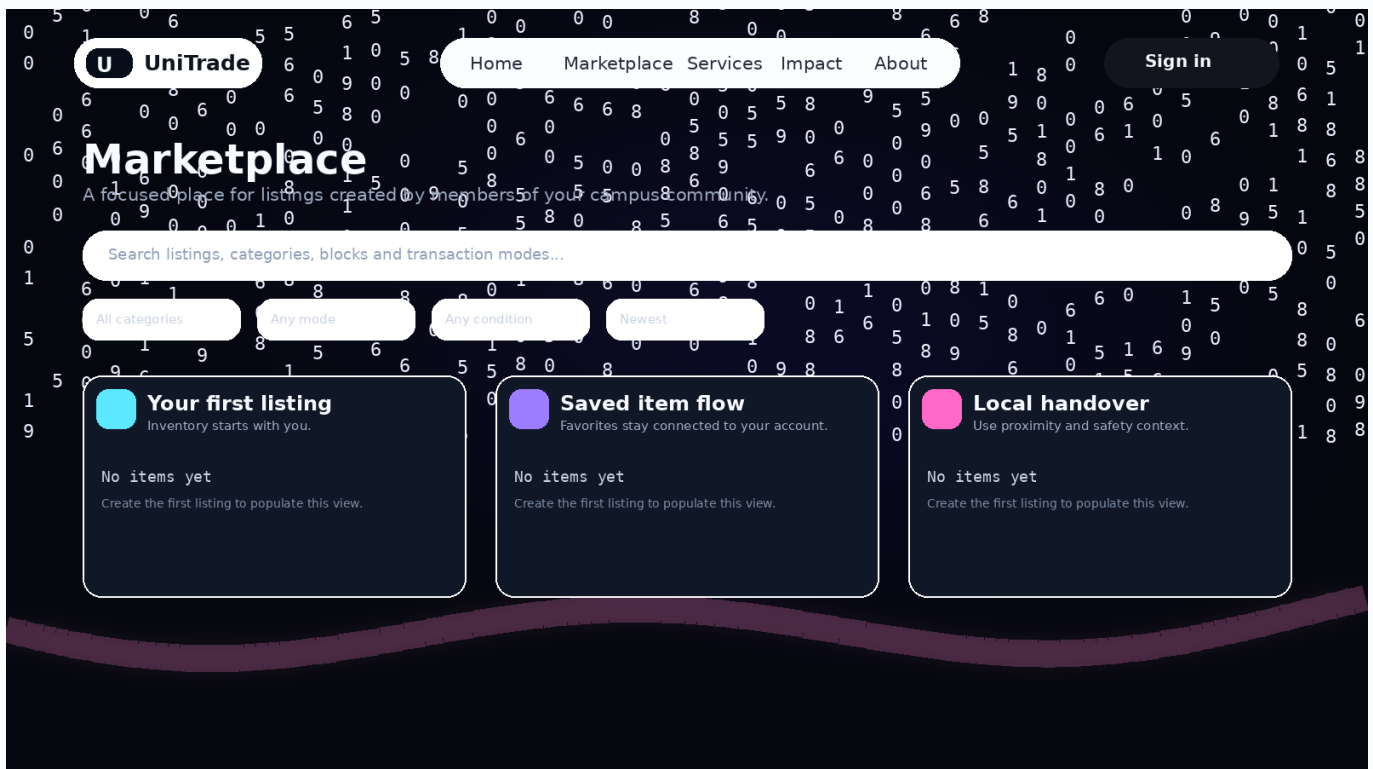
Account creation flow

Step	User action
1	Enter name and email.
2	Create and confirm a password.
3	Add college, course, year and hostel/block.
4	Optionally store a student ID.
5	Agree to responsible-use guidance.
6	Enter the new account workspace.

Passwords are hashed before local storage. The browser stores the current account and product activity locally. This is an interim client-side data layer, not a replacement for server-side identity management.

3. Marketplace experience

The Marketplace view remains useful even when it is empty. Empty states explain the next action and avoid pretending that inventory exists when users have not created it.



Marketplace illustration: global search, filters, focused cards and empty states before the first real listing is created.

Listing workflow

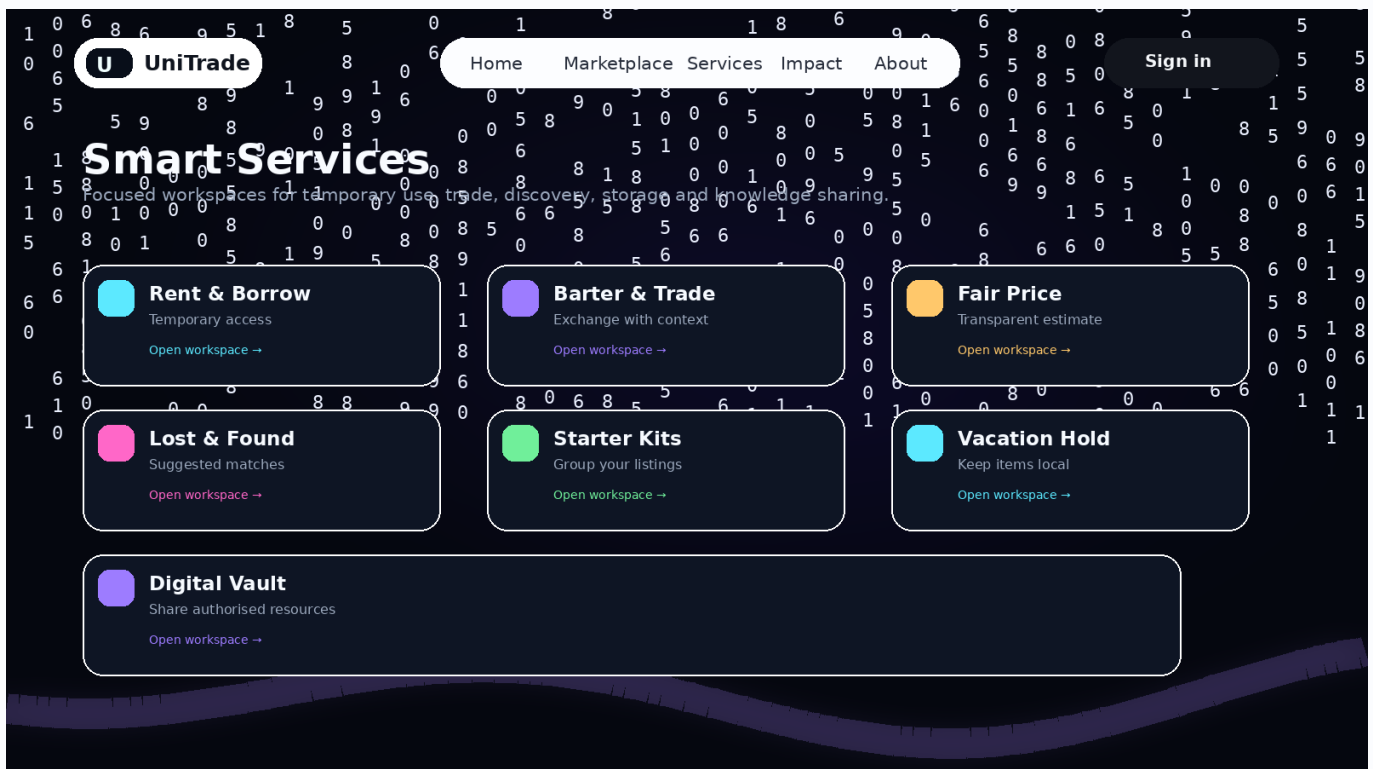
A listing captures title, price, original price, category, transaction mode, condition, hostel/block, walking distance and a detailed description. Supported modes are Buy, Rent, Borrow, Free, Barter and Vacation Hold. Users can view, save, compare, share and report listings. User-created listings persist locally.

Discovery tools

Search covers titles, categories, descriptions, sellers, hostel/block context, transaction modes and tags. Filters narrow by category, mode and condition. Sorting supports newest, price, proximity and reuse-oriented ordering. Recently viewed items and favorites are persisted.

4. Smart Services

Advanced jobs live in separate views so the product stays easy to understand. Every service includes its own description, inputs, workflow and local state.



Service hub illustration: focused workspaces for temporary use, trade, discovery, storage and resource sharing.

Service	Purpose
Rent & Borrow	Plan temporary access with period, deposit, return date and handover notes.
Barter & Trade	Create structured offers between your listing and another listing.
Fair Price	Calculate an explainable resale estimate from item factors.
Lost & Found	Rank possible matches using shared attributes and text similarity.
Starter Kits	Group your own listings into useful bundles.
Fire Sale	Surface end-of-semester listings and price-drop notifications.
Vacation Hold	Plan local storage for cycles, appliances, luggage and other items.
Digital Vault	Share authorised notes and resources with subject and semester context.
Campus Impact	Summarise activity-derived reuse, savings and community measures.

5. Safety and responsible exchange

UniTrade improves local context and provides safety tools without claiming that every transaction is risk-free.

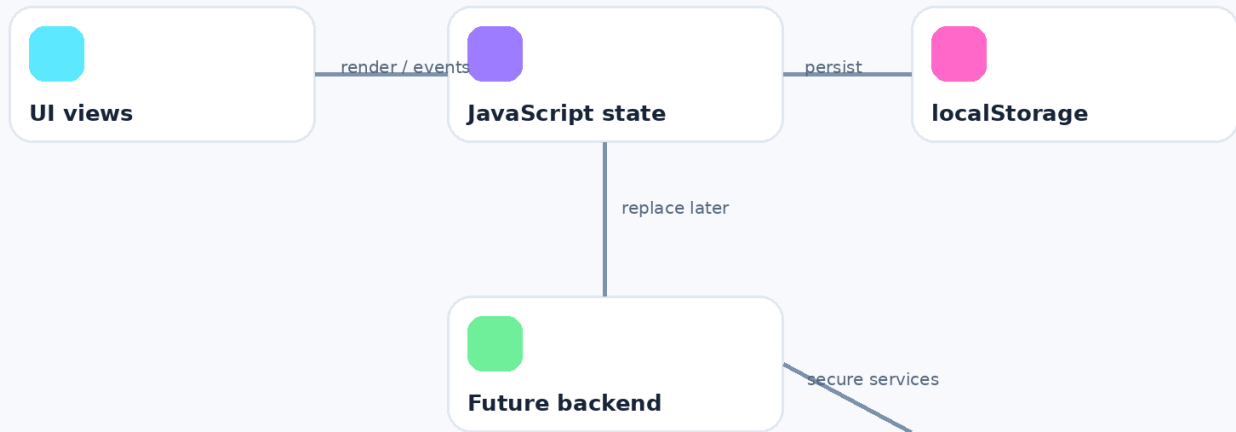
Practice	Guidance
Meet visibly	Use recognized public campus locations for exchanges.
Inspect first	Check item condition before payment or handover.
Protect credentials	Never share passwords, OTPs or sensitive financial information.
Report problems	Use reporting for misleading, unsafe or prohibited content.
Keep records	Record agreed details and handover notes when appropriate.
Escalate unsafe situations	Contact campus authorities when a transaction becomes unsafe.

Current browser persistence

Account and product activity currently stay on the device through localStorage. A future backend should introduce server-side authentication, database access controls, media policies, moderation, audit logs, rate limiting and secure notifications. The frontend is structured so this data layer can be replaced without rebuilding the user experience.

6. Local data architecture

JavaScript owns application state while localStorage persists the relevant collections. The same product data shapes can later be mapped to a secure backend.



Current data path and future replacement boundary.

Stored locally	Later backend equivalent
User account and users	Secure authentication and account database
Listings	Database-backed marketplace records
Favorites and comparison	User preference records
Requests and trade offers	Server-side workflows and notifications
Lost & Found	Search/indexing and moderated reports
Vault resources	Managed storage and access control
Theme/settings	User preferences
Impact metrics	Activity-derived analytics

7. Product tour and navigation model

The website is a multi-view application. Clicking a navigation item opens a focused workspace rather than pushing every feature into one long page. The website tour follows those same routes and places a spotlight around the real area being explained.

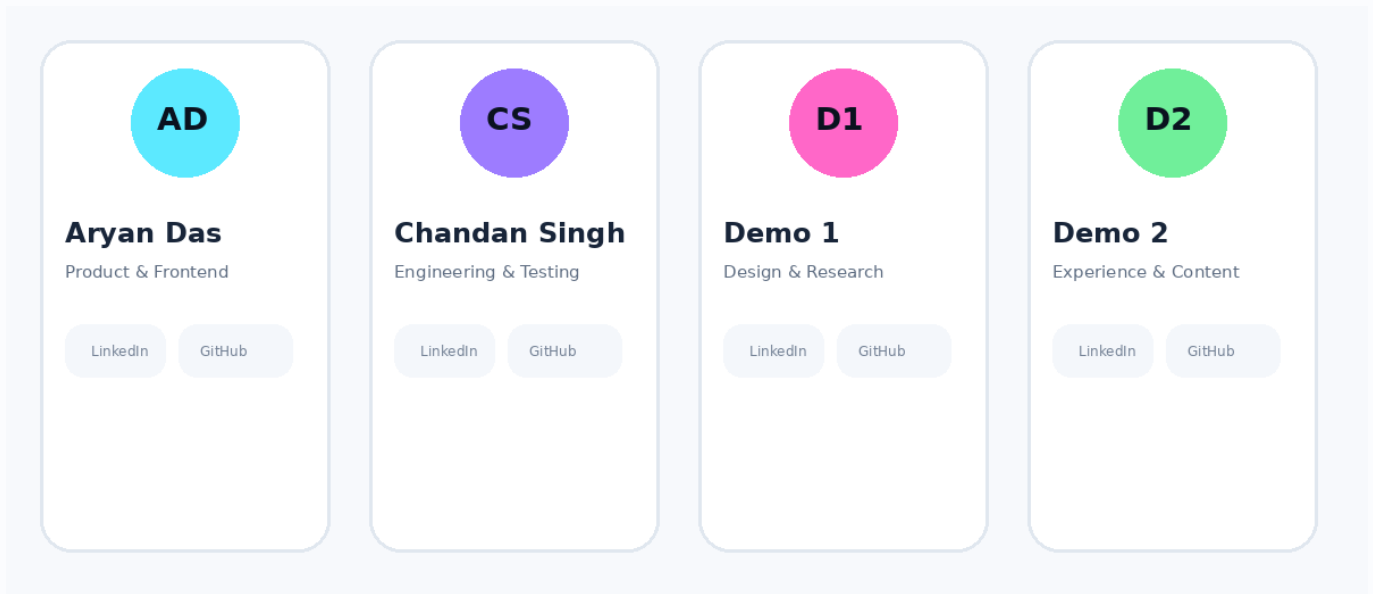
Route	User goal
Home	Understand UniTrade and start a task.
Marketplace	Search and manage listings.
Looking For	Publish a need.
Community	Review Karma and campus activity.
Services	Choose a focused utility.
Impact	See activity-derived sustainability indicators.
Trust & Safety	Learn responsible exchange guidance.
About	Understand the product and principles.
Contributors	Meet the four listed makers.
Guide	Read and download the detailed product handbook.

Tour behavior

Previous, Next, Skip, Close and Restart are available with keyboard arrows and Escape. Completion is stored locally so returning users do not have to repeat the tour unless they restart it.

8. Contributors

The About and Contributors views contain the four makers requested for the product: Aryan Das, Chandan Singh, Demo 1 and Demo 2. LinkedIn and GitHub controls are intentionally disabled until real URLs are supplied rather than pointing to invented accounts.



Contributor card illustration with initials fallback. The live website uses the supplied profile image URL for all four cards and falls back to initials when the external image cannot load.

Profile and social-link policy

The contributor area does not invent additional people, biographies, achievements or social URLs. The two requested placeholder names remain exactly as requested, while their social buttons stay disabled.

9. Product Guide and future backend path

The website includes a dedicated Product Guide view with a visible download action for this PDF. The document explains the product, account model, marketplace, services, safety model, local storage architecture, navigation and the path to a secure backend.

Frontend today	Backend later
Local account state	Secure authentication and sessions
localStorage listings	Database-backed listings
Browser persistence	Multi-device synchronization
External image URLs	Managed media storage
Local notifications	Realtime and push notifications
Client-side estimates	Audited pricing and analytics services
Local reporting	Server-side moderation and audit logs

How to use the current website

Open the website, create an account, publish a listing, save an item, create a Looking For request, explore the service views, and reload the page to verify persistence. The starting state is intentionally empty so every marketplace record comes from the people who use the website.

This guide describes the current commercial product and its upgrade path to secure backend services.